

# Windows Shell Aliases — Cheatsheet

The Windows equivalents of a Mac `.aliases` file, by shell.

PowerShell · most common

## PowerShell

1. Find your profile path:

```
echo $PROFILE
```

2. Create it if missing:

```
if (!(Test-Path $PROFILE)) {  
    New-Item -ItemType File -Path $PROFILE -Force  
}
```

3. Open it:

```
notepad $PROFILE
```

4. Add aliases. Simple renames use `Set-Alias` :

```
Set-Alias ll Get-ChildItem
```

Aliases needing arguments must be functions ( `Set-Alias` can't take parameters):

```
function gs { git status }  
function gco { git checkout $args }
```

5. Reload:

```
. $PROFILE
```

For a separate "aliases file": put functions in `~\aliases.ps1` and dot-source from your profile:

```
. "$HOME\aliases.ps1"
```

cmd.exe

## Command Prompt

cmd uses `doskey` macros, which don't persist on their own.

1. Create `C:\Users\<you>\aliases.cmd` :

```
gs=git status  
ll=dir %*
```

2. Load manually:

```
doskey /macrofile=C:\Users\<you>\aliases.cmd
```

3. Load automatically via AutoRun registry key:

```
reg add "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Command Processor" ^  
    /v AutoRun ^  
    /d "doskey /macrofile=C:\Users\<you>\aliases.cmd" ^  
    /f
```

bash

## Git Bash / WSL

These run a real bash shell, so your Mac approach works almost unchanged. Source a `~/.aliases` file from `~/.bashrc` :

```
# in ~/.bashrc  
[ -f ~/.aliases ] && source ~/.aliases
```

Then put aliases in `~/.aliases` :

```
alias gs='git status'  
alias ll='ls -lah'
```

## Quick Reference

**PowerShell:** `$PROFILE` → `Set-Alias` / `function` → `. $PROFILE`

**cmd:** `doskey` macros → `/macrofile` → AutoRun key to persist

**Git Bash / WSL:** `alias` in `~/.aliases` , sourced from `~/.bashrc`

[Inference] PowerShell is the likeliest match for a modern Windows setup, but the correct shell for your machine is unverified. Based on observed patterns — confirm your shell (PowerShell, cmd, Git Bash, or WSL) for the exact single path.